



INTERN ALSECU

MODULE - 4

MILITARY ACTIONS TAKEN BY INDIA AGAINST STATE SPONSORED TERRORISM

I. SURGICAL STRIKES



- 1 Surgical strike does not mean war:**
Surgical strikes are military operations undertaken by forces across the world to move on the offensive, hit enemy targets and installations, and return to primary positions, all with lightening speed and with the added precaution of suffering limited casualty.

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I. SURGICAL STRIKES

2 Why did India go for this?

- The option of surgical strikes was taken in the wake of increase in infiltration bids.
- Terrorist had begun gathering along LoC and to deal with the threat precisely the best option is to go for surgical strikes.



3 What is the mode of carrying out surgical strikes?

- Can be carried out via air raids, airdropping special operation teams or a ground operation.
- It requires detailed and extensive planning.
- External intelligence is very vital to carry out these strikes.



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I. SURGICAL STRIKES

4 It was a surprise attack!

- The operation not just surprised Pakistan. For the first time, the political leadership in India accepted the trans-LoC operations.
- This action demonstrated the firm intent of India to destroy terror.



5 What did India achieve?

- It gave an important strategic signaling and was considered as a moral victory of the Indian armed forces.
- It gave tremendous confidence to India's special forces.
- It portrayed the professionalism of Indian forces to carryout any operation without fatalities.
- It deterred the Pakistan army from sending infiltrators across the LoC and fomenting violence in Kashmir.

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I. SURGICAL STRIKES

WAY FORWARD

- 1 Over-politicization** of surgical strikes need to stop. Surgical strikes were conducted in the interest of national security, not for political mileage.
- 2 Over-expectations** are not good: One such strike can never force Pakistan Army to mend its ways.
- 3 Capacity building** of our defence forces: Indian security forces need strike drones and modern surveillance equipment very urgently.
- 4 Surgical Strikes are not the answer** to terrorism. To destroy a terrorist base is not the same as destroying terrorism.
- 5** A lasting solution would require a formula that accommodates the **interests of Kashmir**. Kashmir lies at the heart of the cross-border terrorism problem, together with the support terrorism gets from Pakistan.

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II. NON-MILITARY PRE-EMPTIVE ACTIONS



1

Why in news?

- Indian Air Force took a "non-military pre-emptive action" specifically targeted on a Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) terror training camp in Pakistan's Balakot.
- The camp is based 70 km inside the Line of Control (LoC), in the Pakistani province of Khyber Pakthunkhwa.

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II. NON-MILITARY PRE-EMPTIVE ACTIONS



2

What is a non-military pre-emptive strike?

- Non-military strike means that a military target has not been hit.
- A pre-emptive action means that it is based on the assessment of an imminent threat.
- It was said that credible intelligence was received that JeM was attempting suicide terror attack in various parts of the country.

The operation was an intelligence driven, counter-terrorism strike rather than escalatory military aggression.

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II. NON-MILITARY PRE-EMPTIVE ACTIONS



3 Does this signal a shift in India's stance?

- The decision to send Mirage jets across the Line of Control (LoC) to fire missiles 70 km inside Pakistan represents a major shift.
- Notably, during the 1999 Kargil war, Indian PM Vajpayee had drawn a red line over the IAF crossing the LoC, to avoid international accusation.
- India takes note of the shift in global opinion and there is little tolerance today for terror groups that continue to find shelter on Pakistan soil.

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III. HOT PURSUIT



- 1** Hot pursuit refers to tracking and following the enemies (terrorists) beyond the country's borders and neutralizing them.
- 2** Such strikes have altered Indian narrative of the self imposed 'strategic restraint'.
- 3** The open acknowledgement of the operations and creation of favorable world opinion has sent a strong signal.

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III. HOT PURSUIT

Hot Pursuit:

- 1) It refers to the urgent and direct pursuit of a terrorist suspect by law enforcement officers under international rules of engagement for military forces.
- 2) It grants more power to the officers in command than they ordinarily have.

Surgical Strike:

- 1) It is a small-scale precision military attack which is intended to damage military targets only.
- 2) There will be no or minimum collateral damage.



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WHAT IS DOCTRINE OF HOT PURSUIT?

“Hot Pursuit” is also used against terrorists ships out in the open sea, mainly carried out by Navy or Coast guard officers.

- 1** Hot pursuit owes its origin to the law of the seas against vessels that are involved in piracy or smuggling.
- 2** The doctrine vests a right to pursue the delinquent vessel outside the territorial limits into the open sea and they can be taken into custody.
- 3** The fundamental rule of the maritime law states that all vessels have the right to navigate freely on the high seas.
- 4** Yet, the traditional notion has recognized the doctrine of hot pursuit as an exception to the principles of freedom on the high seas.

The doctrine of maritime hot pursuit is codified in Article 111 of the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS).

TERRORISM – ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE AND NON-STATE ACTORS

LONE WOLF ATTACKS

- 1 Lone wolf attacks is when a terror attack is caused by a person (lone wolf) who prepares and commits violent acts alone, outside of any command structure and without material assistance from any group.
- 2 Here there is a single perpetrator with no hierarchical command structure.
- 3 Usually family members are not aware of the radicalisation of the individual.

A large number of terrorists initially claimed by authorities and reporters to have been lone wolf attacks inspired by ISIS or its ideology, were later found to have been recruited, trained and directed by ISIS to carry out the attacks. This would mean they were technically not Lone Wolves.

CONVENTIONAL TERROR ATTACKS

- 1 The conventional terror attacks mostly had multiple perpetrators with a definite command structure.
- 2 Usually the family members are aware of the events.



TERRORISM – ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE AND NON-STATE ACTORS

CAUSES OF LONE WOLF ATTACKS



Lax gun
controls



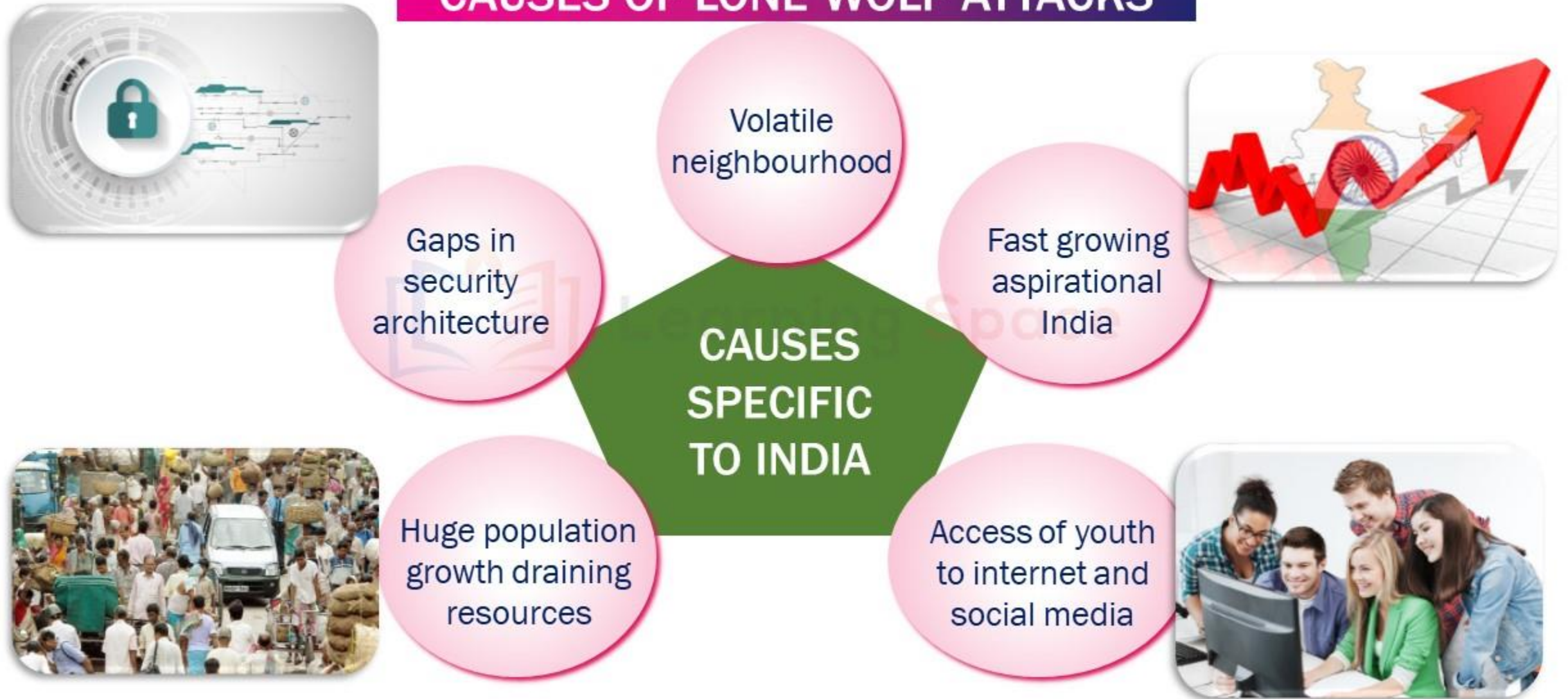
CAUSES

Mental and
psychological
disorders

Alienation and
breakage of
social cohesion

TERRORISM – ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE AND NON-STATE ACTORS

CAUSES OF LONE WOLF ATTACKS



TERRORISM – ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE AND NON-STATE ACTORS

WHAT MAKES TARGETING LONE WOLF ATTACKS DIFFICULT?

1

Intelligence nightmare:

- Traditional terror groups are easier to control.
- Whereas, leaderless resistance create an intelligence nightmare



2

Use of social media:

- False propaganda and indoctrination of youth
- Terrorist find recruits via social media.
- The head of Al-Qaeda Indian Subcontinent called on Indian Muslims to follow the example of lone wolves in Europe and kill officers in India.

3

Possibilities of a complex network:

- Recent studies have shown that these attacks are not entirely independent of each other.
- They exercise various degrees of influence acting as confidants, coaches etc.



TERRORISM – ROLE OF EXTERNAL STATE AND NON-STATE ACTORS

PRE-EMPTIVE STEPS TAKEN BY INDIA

5 Deployment of private security at high value targets like malls, hotels and schools has been upgraded, which acts as a deterrent to an individual aiming to target them.

4 WHAM strategy approach by security forces to prevent alienation.



STEPS TAKEN

1 Modernization of madrassas, Employment and skilling schemes for jobless youth like Nai Manzil, Himayat etc.

2 Specific programmes like 'Operation Chakravyuh' of the IB, where a dedicated set of officers monitor the web, tracing the activities of the youth who are in touch with terror operatives.

3 NATGRID and National Cyber Coordination Centre (NCCC) is in the process of being scaled up.



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